

Public Sector Case Triage Copilot

Every step, start to finish, including the current (2026) way to build the tool in Step 6 — an agent flow populating a Word template and saving to SharePoint.

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What You're Building

An agent that triages new citizen cases and drafts plain-language acknowledgement letters, grounded in one data file, acting through one governed tool.

AGENT NAME	Public Sector Case Triage Copilot
ORCHESTRATION	Generative (AI-led)
KNOWLEDGE	PublicSector_Cases_Data.xlsx
CUSTOM TOPIC	Triage New Case
TOOL	Create Acknowledgement Letter Draft in Word (agent flow → Word template + SharePoint)

Files & Where They Go

FILE / ITEM	GOES TO	USED IN
PublicSector_Cases_Data.xlsx	Copilot Studio → Knowledge tab → Add knowledge → File	Step 3
Acknowledgement Letter .docx template	Author with content controls, upload to SharePoint — see Step 6a	Step 6

Before you start — confirm Environment Maker permission, Word for the web / Microsoft 365 licensing for the template-population action, and Contribute access on the SharePoint library holding the template and drafts.

Set Up the Agent

Steps 1–3 — create the agent shell, pick how it reasons, and ground it in data.

1 Create Your Copilot Studio Agent

Open Copilot Studio (copilotstudio.microsoft.com), select **Create** → **New agent**, then configure:

AGENT NAME	Public Sector Case Triage Copilot
DESCRIPTION	Triages incoming citizen and member requests across housing, benefits, permits, complaints and information — categorises, prioritises by SLA, and drafts plain-language acknowledgement letters.
SOLUTION / ENVIRONMENT	Public Sector Operations · Default environment
ICON	Use a recognisable colour and emoji or upload a brand icon

2 Choose Orchestration Mode

Under **Settings** → **Generative AI**, use **Generative Orchestration** (AI-led) so the agent can blend knowledge lookups with tool calls for citizen case triage and SLA management.

3 Add Knowledge

Knowledge tab → **Add knowledge** → **File** → upload **PublicSector_Cases_Data.xlsx**. Contains:

- Case metadata (case ID, category — Housing / Benefits / Permits / Complaints / Info)
- Lifecycle (submitted date, SLA days, days open, status — New / In progress / Resolved / Closed)
- Priority and channel (Low / Med / High; Web / Phone / Walk-in / Post)
- Citizen context (citizen reference code, assigned officer, summary)

You can layer additional sources later — SharePoint sites, Dataverse, public web, or Graph connectors.

Behavior: Instructions & Topic

Steps 4–5 — tell the agent how to behave, then give it a reusable conversation flow.

4 Add Agent Instructions

Overview → Instructions — paste exactly:

You are the Public Sector Case Triage Copilot. You help two audiences:

- 1) Front-line case officers triaging the queue.
- 2) Service managers monitoring SLA risk and channel mix.

Rules:

- Use the uploaded cases dataset as your single source of truth.
- Write in plain language at roughly an 8th-grade reading level.
- Be accessibility-aware: short sentences, no jargon, no Latin abbreviations.
- For acknowledgement letters, call the 'Create Acknowledgement Letter' tool.
- For SLA risk, surface cases where DaysOpen approaches or exceeds SLA_Days.
- Treat citizen references as confidential – never expose another citizen's case to an unrelated officer or channel.

5 Add a Custom Topic

Topics → Add a topic → Create from description:

Topic name: Triage New Case

Description: Walks a case officer through categorising and prioritising a new citizen request, picks the right SLA, and offers to draft an acknowledgement letter for the citizen.

Trigger phrases:

- Triage a new case
- Help me categorise this request
- What's the SLA for this
- Acknowledge the new request from CIT-7821

Conversation steps:

- Ask for: citizen reference (optional), channel, free-text summary
- Suggest a Category from {Housing, Benefits, Permits, Complaints, Info}
- Suggest Priority from {Low, Med, High} based on summary keywords
- Calculate target SLA in days from category and priority (cite the rule)
- Read the suggestion back to the officer and ask to confirm or override
- Call 'Create Acknowledgement Letter' tool with the confirmed category and SLA

Build the Tool (Current Method)

Step 6 — updated for 2026, using current Copilot Studio tool-building.

6a Author the Word Template

In Word, create **AcknowledgementLetter_Template.docx** with content controls (Developer tab → Plain Text Content Control) named exactly: **CitizenRef**, **Category**, **SLA**, **OfficerName**, **PersonalisationNote**. Upload it to a SharePoint library, e.g. **Letter Templates**.

6b Build the Agent Flow

1. **Flows** → **New flow** → **Agent flow**.
2. Trigger inputs: **CitizenRef**, **Category**, **SLA**, **OfficerName**, **PersonalisationNote**.
3. Action: **Word Online (Business) — Populate a Microsoft Word template** → select the template from the Letter Templates library → map each content control to its input.
4. Action: **SharePoint — Create file** → save the generated letter into a Drafts library.
5. Action: **Teams — Post your own adaptive card as the Flow bot to a channel** → the case officer's team, for review before send.
6. **Respond to the agent** → output **DraftLetterURL**. Confirm **Asynchronous response = Off**.
7. **Publish** the flow.

6c Attach It as a Tool

1. **Tools** → **Add a tool** → filter by **Flow** → select it → **Add and configure**.
2. **Name**: Create Acknowledgement Letter Draft in Word. **Description**: "Creates a plain-language acknowledgement letter draft from the approved template."
3. Under **Completion**, respond using **DraftLetterURL**.
4. **Save**.

Original spec, for reference — Tool: Create Acknowledgement Letter Draft in Word. Type: Word for the web connector (Create document from template) + SharePoint save. Creates a plain-language acknowledgement letter draft from the approved Word template, populated with citizen reference, category, SLA, and the assigned officer name. Inputs: Citizen reference code (string); Category (Housing / Benefits / Permits / Complaints / Info); SLA in days (number); Assigned officer (from authenticated user); Optional personalisation note (string). Outcome: Returns the SharePoint URL of the draft letter and posts an approval card to the case officer's team channel for review before send.

Configure, Evaluate, Test, Publish

Steps 7–10 — lock down settings, prove quality, and ship it.

7 Configure Settings

Settings cog (top right) — four areas before real users touch the agent:

- **General** — confirm name, description, primary language
- **Generative AI** — orchestration mode, content moderation (start at Medium)
- **Authentication** — "Authenticate with Microsoft" so the agent runs as the signed-in user
- **Security** — review DLP policy, enabled channels, end-user authentication

8 Evaluate Your Agent

Analytics → **Evaluations** → **New evaluation** — "Public Sector Case Triage — Baseline v1". Score every response on Groundedness, Relevance, Accuracy.

Input: Show all High priority cases breaching SLA today

Expect: Filters Priority=High AND DaysOpen >= SLA_Days; lists with citizen reference codes.

Input: How many cases came in via Walk-in last week by category?

Expect: Filters Channel=Walk-in within 7 days, groups by Category, returns counts.

Input: Draft an acknowledgement letter for CIT-7821, housing repair request

Expect: Triggers Triage New Case topic and calls Create Acknowledgement Letter Draft in Word.

9 Test in the Test Pane

For each query, open **Activity map** to see: which topic/tool/knowledge fired, the inputs collected and outputs returned, citations to source rows, and per-step latency.

10 Publish to a Channel

Recommended for this build: Custom Demo website — many front-line officers don't have Teams licences. Use a **custom website (demo/intranet)** as the primary surface for front-line officers; **Microsoft Teams** for service managers and supervisors reviewing SLA risk; **Microsoft 365 Copilot** for back-office and policy teams; or **Telephony** (Azure Communication Services) to capture phone-channel cases directly. Teams and M365 Copilot channels require tenant admin approval.

Try These Live

Sample queries to run once the agent is built — and what it replaces.

Queue Triage

- Show all High priority cases currently breaching SLA.
- Which categories have the most New cases this week?

Plain-Language Drafting

- Draft an acknowledgement letter for CIT-7821, housing repair request.
- Rewrite this case summary in plain English for the citizen.

SLA & Channel Mix

- What's the average days-to-resolve by category?
- How many cases arrived via Walk-in last week?

This agent replaces

- Manual queue categorisation
- Hand-written acknowledgement letters
- Spreadsheet SLA trackers refreshed nightly

With

- Consistent triage decisions, audit-trailed
- Plain-language letters drafted in seconds
- SLA risk surfaced before it becomes a complaint

Tip for real-world use — publish to a custom website channel — many front-line officers don't have a Teams licence. Run accessibility checks on the Word template (alt text, reading order, language tags) so generated letters meet your standard from day one.